Sl. No.	Year	Name of the study Team / Committee	Chairman
7.	1963	Study Team on Panchayati Raj Finances	K. Santhanam
8.	1965	Committee on Panchayati Raj Elections	K. Santhanam
9.	1965	Study Team on the Audit and Accounts of Panchayati Raj Bodies	R.K. Khanna
10.	1966	Committee on Panchayati Raj Training Centres	G. Ramachandran
11.	1969	Study Team on Involvement of Community Development Agency and Panchayati Raj Institutions in the Implementation of Basic Land Reform Measures	V. Ramanathan
12.	1972	Working Group for Formulation of Fifth Five Year Plan on Community Development and Panchayati Raj	N. Ramakrishnayya
13.	1976	Committee on Community Development and Panchayati Raj	Smt. Daya Choubey



Ashok Mehta Committee

In December 1977, the Janata Government appointed a committee on panchayati raj institutions under the chairmanship of Ashok Mehta. It submitted its report in August 1978 and made 132 recommendations to revive and strengthen the declining panchayati raj system in the country. Its main recommendations were:

1. The three-tier system of panchayati raj should be replaced by the two-tier system, that is, zila parishad at the district level, and below it, the mandal panchayat consisting of a group of villages with a total population of 15,000 to 20,000.
2. A district should be the first point for decentralisation under popular supervision below the state level.
3. Zila parishad should be the executive body and made responsible for planning at the district level.
4. There should be an official participation of political parties at all levels of panchayat elections.
5. The panchayati raj institutions should have compulsory powers of taxation to mobilise their own financial resources.